# NMDC

## *Surging Ahead with an Iron Fist*



***Sumit Deb***
**CMD, National Mineral Development Corporation (NMDC) Ltd.**

> *"The growth trajectory of our performance in the last quarter has been exceptional and displays NMDC's commitment towards a self-sufficient nation by setting new benchmarks."*

Overseeing a Rs. 6000 crore expansion plan to increase production to 100 million tonnes by 2030 from 42 million tonnes as of today is, by no means, an easy task. And that's why the man steering the country's largest public sector iron ore producer National Mineral Development Corporation (NMDC) Ltd, Hyderabad, for over two years now is important. Chairman and MD Sumit Deb is touted to be bullish on expansion. The increased production will be in line with the government's plan for 300 million tonnes National Steel capacity, promised Deb.

Around two and half years ago, Sumit Deb took charge of NMDC as CMD, a Navratna PSU headquartered in Hyderabad, which is strategically located close to the rich mineral belt of the country extending to states like Odisha, Karnataka, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and Telangana. It was a time when he had to wrestle his way into the renewal of mining leases in states. All this while simultaneously working on a Rs. 6,000 crore capacity expansion plan. Unfortunately for Deb, the pandemic, along with inclement weather conditions, proved to be major hurdles slowing down mobility, production and progress. Bailadila in Chhattisgarh and Donimalai in Karnataka, two of the largest mines of the sector, were worst affected during monsoon. Moreover, the demand for steel was tepid, impacting iron ore production to a large extent.

Earlier this year, the government had imposed 15% duty on flat steel and alloys, 50% on all grades of iron ore and 45% on pellets. While Deb insists that NMDC has not been exporting as a matter of policy of the Government of India and that the organization wants to see that the ore is available for domestic markets, online stock-trading platform Motilal Oswal suggests that reduction in steel production post the imposition of export duty on steel and pellets led to sharp correction in sales in H1 of FY23. However Deb is confident that